PIA2050 Comparative Politics and Societies — Week 5 Summary: A Survey of Regime Types

1. Framing: How Nation-States Differ

Keywords: nation-state, national content, state capacity, regime type

- **Last week (slide 2):** state-formation and nation-building — why the world is dominated by "nation-states", i.e. states that govern one nation.
- **This week:** how nation-states **differ**, along three dimensions (slide 2):
    - **National content** — do state and nation boundaries coincide? (Section 2)
    - **State capacity** — the "degree of government", or the state's varying effectiveness in governing/serving a population (Section 3)
    - **Regime** — esp. **democracy vs non-democracy** and the **subtypes of non-democracy** (Sections 4–8)
- → Study cue: for any country, ask in order — nation-state or not? how capable? which regime type?

2. National Content

Keywords: multi-national state, sub-national state, stateness, Linz and Stepan, citizenship

2.1 State–Nation Mismatch (slides 3–4)

Keywords: dominant form, multi-national, sub-national, contested nationhood

- The nation-state is the **dominant** form of political organisation, but **not the only one**: in some countries the state's territory does not coincide with that of a single nation (slide 3).
- Two mismatch types (memorise):
    - Multi-national state — a state inhabited by more than one nation.
    - Sub-national state — a state inhabited by less than a whole nation.
- Examples are **contested**, because a nation only really exists in the minds of its members (slide 4).

2.2 The Stateness Problem (slide 4)

Keywords: stateness, stability, suitability for democracy, secession, cleansing, rules of the game

- Linz & Stepan 1996: the problem of "stateness" — the lack of correspondence between state and nation — is very consequential for a country's **stability** and **suitability for democracy**.
- **Stability:** no agreement on **who is a "citizen"**; multi-national states may face **secession** attempts or efforts to **"cleanse"** the polity of undesired minorities.
- **Democracy:** hard to envision a **lasting agreement on the rules of the game** or **commitment to democratic means**.
- → Chain (memorise): **state ≠ nation → dispute over who the demos is → no consensus on rules → instability, weak democracy.**

3. State Capacity

Keywords: effective, flawed, weak, collapsed/failed, penetration, legitimacy, Siaroff

- States differ in capacity to **control/serve the population**, and not always **uniformly across the territory** (slide 5).
- Textbook (Siaroff 2013, Ch. 3) — four types, most to least capable (memorise): **Effective → Flawed → Weak → Collapsed**.

3.1 Effective State (slide 5)

Keywords: default category, territorial control, rational-legal bureaucracy, taxation, legitimacy

- Default category: a state that "controls the national territory and the borders and has sufficient domestic penetration to ensure that national laws and policies are in effect throughout the country".
- Requires a **stable judicial system**, a **rational-legal bureaucracy**, and capacity to **raise taxes** and **provide basic services** (*Example:* public education, public health).
- **Legitimate all over the country and among all social classes.**

3.2 Flawed and Weak States (slide 6)

Keywords: shallow penetration, corruption, tax avoidance, outside government control, predatory officials

- Flawed state — "not as effective in terms of depth of penetration or legitimacy":
    - Lower **bureaucratic quality**; more **corruption** and **tax avoidance**; problematic **economic performance**; more **riots and rebellions**.
- Weak state — "even less effective than a flawed state in that actual areas of the country are outside of government control":
    - Cannot impose national policies everywhere; effect may be limited to **the capital and adjacent areas**.
    - Elsewhere **absent**, or its presence is **illegitimate and ignored**.

    - Officials may **enrich themselves** rather than follow legal obligations; **inadequate for economic and social development**.

- → Flawed = governs everywhere, badly; weak = does **not govern parts** of the country at all.

3.3 Collapsed (Failed) State (slide 7)

Keywords: anarchy, multi-actor civil war, warlords, frontline caveat, Yemen, Libya

- Collapsed state — "truly no state authority but rather anarchy, multi-actor civil war, or fragmentation into various autonomous regional areas, often controlled by warlords".
- **Caveat (memorise):** a civil war dividing the country **along a frontline** is **not** collapse if a national government still controls "its" territory and adjacent borders (but not rebel territory).
- **Cases (Table 3.1, end 2021):** only **Yemen** and **Libya** collapsed; **Somalia** by some measures.
    - *Example:* collapsed but since **re-established** — Afghanistan, Angola, Burundi, DRC (Kinshasa), Iraq, Lebanon, Liberia, Sierra Leone.
- → Capacity is a **variable**; collapse is reversible.

3.4 The Data: State Strength and Fragility (slides 8–10)

Keywords: Siaroff Table 3.1, Fragile States Index, Fund for Peace, capacity vs regime

- **Table 3.1, Levels of State Strength (end of 2021)** (slide 8), Siaroff 2022:
    - **Effective:** e.g. Australia, Canada, Chile, **China**, Japan, South Korea, Singapore, Taiwan, the UK, the US, **Vietnam**, the UAE, Qatar.
    - **Flawed:** e.g. Brazil, **India**, Indonesia, Philippines, Russia, Thailand, Turkey, South Africa, Egypt, Iran, North Korea.
    - **Weak:** e.g. Afghanistan, Colombia, DR Congo, Ethiopia, Haiti, Lebanon, **Mexico**, Myanmar, Nigeria, Somalia, Syria, Ukraine, Venezuela.
    - **Collapsed:** only **Libya** and **Yemen**.
- → **Capacity ≠ democracy** (memorise): autocratic China and Vietnam are *effective*; democratic India is *flawed*; Mexico is *weak*.
- Fragile States Index (Fund for Peace; maps on slides 9–10): a 0–120 score of vulnerability to conflict or collapse; lower = more stable. Bands: **Sustainable → Stable → Warning → Alert**.
    - *Example:* most stable (2023) — **Norway 14.5**, Iceland, Finland, New Zealand, Switzerland, Denmark; most fragile — **Somalia 111.9**, Yemen, South Sudan, DR Congo, Syria, Afghanistan, Sudan, CAR, Chad, Haiti.
    - Pattern: the Alert zone clusters in the **Sahel–Horn of Africa–Middle East** belt.

4. Regimes: Definition and Map

Keywords: political regime, selection method, repression, incumbents, democracy, hybrid, autocracy

4.1 What a Regime Is (slide 11)

Keywords: formal and informal structure, representation, regime vs government

- Political regime — "the formal and informal structure of state and governmental roles and processes".
- Includes: **method of selecting** government and assemblies (election, coup, military decision, royal prerogative); **mechanisms of representation**; **patterns of repression**.
- Distinct from: **incumbents**, their **supporting coalition**, and their **policies** (except policies that define/transform the regime).
- → Regime = **rules of the game**; government = **current players**. A new party winning ≠ regime change; a coup ending elections = regime change.

4.2 Classification Map (slide 11)

Keywords: democracy vs non-democracy, hybrid regimes, authoritarianism, totalitarianism, sultanism

- **Democracy** → liberal / electoral.
- **Non-democracy** → **hybrid regimes** + **autocracy** (authoritarianism, totalitarianism, sultanism; plus post-totalitarianism).

5. Democracy: Origins and Core Definitions

Keywords: demos, Athens, direct democracy, Przeworski, Lincoln, uncertainty

5.1 Athenian Direct Democracy (slides 12–13)

Keywords: polis, agora, psephos, idiotes, lottery, metics, exclusion

- Democracy — more accurately "rule of the demos" than "rule of the people" (slide 12).
- Athens pioneered direct democracy, **500–322 BCE**: the demos took part in judicial/legislative affairs and could hold public office.
- Citizens met in the **agora**, heard speeches, voted with **psephos** (coloured stones / bronze ballots).
- Good citizen = participates **rationally, without self-interest**; non-participants = **idiotes**.
- **Legacy (slide 13):** sovereignty of the demos + public deliberation → foundations of modern **accountability**.
- **Limits:** offices filled by **lottery**, not elections; **no individual equality**.
    - Excluded: slaves and **metics** (2/3 of population), women, men without property or military service.

- Demos ≈ **30,000 male household heads of ~300,000 (~10%)** (memorise).

5.2 Przeworski and Lincoln (slide 14)

Keywords: parties lose elections, institutionalised uncertainty, real choice

- Przeworski: "Democracy is a system in which parties lose elections." → citizens need a **real choice between viable, highly aggregated alternatives**.
- Przeworski: "The process of establishing a democracy is a process of institutionalizing uncertainty, of subjecting all interests to uncertainty." → **rules guaranteeing true competition**.
- **Lincoln:** "Government of the people, by the people, and for the people."
- → Test (memorise): **can the incumbents lose?** If the result is known in advance, there is no democracy.

6. Modern Democracy: Criteria and Categories

Keywords: polyarchy, Dahl, Schmitter and Karl, electoralism, Fukuyama, liberal vs electoral democracy

6.1 Dahl's Polyarchy (slides 15–16)

Keywords: representation, elections, suffrage, expression, information, association

- Modern "people" rule only **indirectly, via representatives**. To avoid deciding whether that is truly "rule of the people", Dahl 1982 coined polyarchy — polyarchy, or "modern political democracy" — requiring (memorise all seven):
  - **(1) Elected officials** constitutionally control policy decisions.
  - **(2) Free, fair, frequent elections** choose and **peacefully remove** officials; coercion quite limited.
  - **(3) Practically all adults can vote.**
  - **(4) Most adults can run** for office.
  - **(5) Effectively enforced freedom of expression**, incl. criticism of officials, government, the prevailing system and dominant ideology.
  - **(6) Alternative information** not monopolised by government or any single group.
  - **(7) Associational autonomy** — right to form/join parties and interest groups competing peacefully.
- → (1)–(4) = **elections**; (5)–(7) = **freedoms that make elections meaningful**.

6.2 Schmitter & Karl's Additions (slide 17)

Keywords: unelected veto players, electoralism, self-governing polity

- Schmitter & Karl 1991 add:

    - **(8)** Elected officials exercise powers **without overriding (even informal) opposition from unelected officials** — military officers, entrenched civil servants, state managers must not act independently or **veto** elected decisions.
    - **(9)** The polity is **self-governing**, free of constraints from an **overarching political system**.

- (8) guards against electoralism — the tendency to focus on the holding of elections while ignoring other political realities.
- *Example:* elections held but the army can overturn results → fails (8).

6.3 Fukuyama's Three Elements (slide 18)

Keywords: Origins of Political Order, modern state, Weber, rule of law, accountability

- Fukuyama 2011: liberal democracy combines:
    - **Modern state** — Weber: "an organization that exercises a monopoly over the legitimate use of violence in a finite territory".
    - **Rule of law** — law applies to everyone equally and constrains state power rather than enabling it.
    - **Accountability** — ways for citizens to remove governments that do not serve the interests of society.
- **Origins (memorise):** modern state first in **China**; rule of law and accountability in the **"West"**.

6.4 Nationalism, Sovereignty, Citizenship (slide 19)

Keywords: popular sovereignty, equal citizenship, elections, limits on power

- Rule of law and accountability spread **together with popular nationalism** and its ideas of sovereignty and citizenship.
- Popular sovereignty — political power ultimately resides in or springs from the people → justifies **general elections** to choose governments and **reward/punish** officials.
- Equal citizenship → **limits on state power** protect citizens' rights; at its broadest, **equal right of all to participate** in community decisions.
- → Links to Section 2.2: democracy needs an agreed "people" to be sovereign.

6.5 Majority Rule + Minority Rights (slide 20)

Keywords: liberal democracy, electoral democracy, liberal autocracy

- Formula (memorise): **Democracy = Majority rule + Minority rights** — free, fair, competitive elections plus "liberal" rights protecting minorities.
- Liberal democracy — meets both criteria.
- Electoral democracy — meets only majority rule.
- Liberal autocracy — liberal rights without majority rule; only **one example** was ever offered (commonly cited: British colonial Hong Kong).

- **Debate:** can elections be truly free/fair/competitive **without freedoms of speech, association, assembly**? If not, electoral democracies are not really democracies.

7. Measuring Regimes and Hybrid Regimes

Keywords: Freedom House, Partly Free, hybrid, transitional, entrenched, autocracy

7.1 Five Democracy Indices Compared (slides 21–23, 30)

Keywords: EIU, Freedom House, Polity, V-Dem, International IDEA, scales, categories

- Five big surveys of democracy (slide 21) (memorise: who, how often, scale):
  - EIU Democracy Index — annual; 165 countries + 2 territories; **full democracy / flawed democracy / hybrid regime / authoritarian regime**; **0–10**.
  - Freedom House, Freedom in the World — annual; 195 countries + 15 territories; **Free / Partly Free / Not Free**; **0–100**.
  - Polity — annual; 163 countries; **democracy / anocracy / autocracy**; **−10 to +10**.
  - V-Dem — annual; 202 countries and territories; **no overall categories**; **0–1**. Really five indices (electoral, liberal, participatory, deliberative, egalitarian); the electoral index is built into the other four.
  - International IDEA — **biennial**; 165 countries; **democracy / hybrid regime / authoritarian regime** (democracy further divided); **0–1**.
- Maps: V-Dem additive polyarchy index 2025 (slide 22); EIU "State of Democracy" (slide 23).
- **EIU 2024 headline (slide 30):** global average **5.2/10**, declining slightly; **60 countries** under authoritarian rule. Share of world population:
  - **Authoritarian 39.2%**, **flawed democracy 38.4%**, **hybrid 15.7%**, **full democracy 6.6%** (memorise).
- → Indices broadly agree on the extremes but use different cut-points and categories, so always say **which index** a classification comes from.

7.2 Freedom House (slides 24–25)

Keywords: Free, Partly Free, Not Free, political rights, civil liberties

- Ratings: **"Free"**, **"Partly Free"**, **"Not Free"**, scored on **political rights** and **civil liberties**.
- → Political rights ≈ majority rule; civil liberties ≈ minority rights.

7.3 Regime Counts at the End of 2021 (slides 26–28, 34)

Keywords: Table 4.1, 195 regimes, liberal, electoral, semi-liberal, closed, Freedom House trends

- **Table 4.1, Democracies and Autocracies (end 2021)**, Siaroff 2022: **195 regimes in total** (memorise):
    - **Liberal democracies — 39** (slide 26): e.g. Canada, Chile, Germany, South Korea, **Taiwan**, the UK, the **US**, Uruguay.
    - **Electoral democracies — 67** (slide 26): e.g. Brazil, **India**, Indonesia, Israel, **Japan**, Mexico, Poland, Ukraine.
    - **Semi-liberal autocracies — 48** (slide 34): e.g. Hungary, Iran, Malaysia, Pakistan, Russia, **Singapore**, Thailand, Turkey.
    - **Closed autocracies — 41** (slide 34): e.g. Afghanistan, **China**, Cuba, Egypt, **North Korea**, Myanmar, Saudi Arabia, Syria, Venezuela, Vietnam.
    - Check: 39 + 67 + 48 + 41 = 195. Democracies 106 vs autocracies 89.
- **Freedom House change maps 2023→2024** (slides 27–28): each country coded **declined 3+ / declined 1–2 / no change / improved 1–2 / improved 3+**; declines outnumber improvements → continuing **democratic recession**.

7.4 Breaking Down Non-Democracy (slide 29)

Keywords: self-rule, closed vs semi-liberal autocracy, transitional, entrenched

- **Partly Free** = hybrid regimes; **Not Free** = autocracies.
- Textbook only uses **"Closed Autocracy"** and **"Semi-Liberal Autocracy"** (most hybrids are semi-liberal).
- Autocracy — literally "self-rule"; the rule of any individual or group not accountable to the population.
- Hybrids are either transitional — moving from one regime type to another or entrenched — relatively stable; many typologies exist.

7.5 Four Regime Types Compared: Table 4.2 (slide 31)

Keywords: liberal democracy, electoral democracy, semi-liberal autocracy, closed autocracy, Linz & Stepan dimensions

- Siaroff 2022 Table 4.2, built on Linz & Stepan 1996: ten dimensions (parties/elections, pluralism, civil liberties, ideology, mobilization, legitimacy, constraints, accountability, leadership duration, transition).
- **Liberal democracy:**
    - Free and fair competition among 2+ parties; citizens can change the government; strong, open opposition.
    - **Full civil liberties**; many autonomous actors.
    - Ideology stresses civilian authority, rule of law, individualism, minority rights.
    - **Legal-rational legitimacy**; clearly constrained by constitution, courts, rule of law, professional bureaucracy.
    - Leaders face periodic free elections; transfers are smooth.

- **Electoral democracy:**
  - Citizens can change the government, but elections are **sometimes not completely free and fair**.
  - Civil liberties **usually incomplete**; usually no formal ideology.
  - Constrained by the constitution but **only somewhat** by courts and the rule of law.
  - **Tutelary actors** may be shielded from elections.
  - Path to liberal democracy: gradual removal of the remaining barriers.
- **Semi-liberal autocracy:**
  - Usually more than one party, but elections are **not free and fair enough to change the government**.
  - Civil liberties limited; some pluralism, perhaps predating the regime.
  - Legitimacy includes the **illusion of legal-rational authority**; constrained more by society (esp. **independent media**) than by courts.
  - **No true accountability**; elections "confirm" new leaders.
  - Transition: a stable negotiated transition is possible where civil society is developed.
- **Closed autocracy:**
  - One official party or none; **no or next to no civil liberties**; no significant social pluralism.
  - Usually nationalistic; stresses **demobilization**.
  - Legitimacy from **tradition and the national interest**; leader has legally undefined limits but is checked in practice by the bureaucracy, military and business.
  - **Leadership for life** unless overthrown.
  - Transition must first pass through a semi-liberal phase, unless the regime is defeated in war and occupied by a foreign power willing to democratize.
- → Two cut-lines (memorise): **free and fair elections that can change the government** (democracy vs autocracy); **full vs partial liberties** (liberal vs electoral; semi-liberal vs closed).

7.6 Entrenched Hybrid Varieties (slide 32)

Keywords: pseudo-democracy, competitive authoritarianism, tutelary democracy, delegative democracy

- Pseudo-democracy — elections without real competition because the deck is stacked against the opposition, plus heavy restrictions on rights.
- Competitive authoritarianism — like pseudo-democracy, but some regional/national domains are open to real competition, where the government can lose.

- Tutelary democracy — Przeworski 1988: "a regime which has competitive, formally democratic institutions, but in which the power apparatus [...] retains the capacity to intervene to correct undesirable states of affairs".
- Delegative democracy — free/fair elections anyone can win, but governments face little accountability and can trample minority rights without consequences.
- Which criterion each fails (memorise):
    - Pseudo-democracy → Przeworski's "parties lose" test.
    - Competitive authoritarianism → passes it only in some arenas.
    - Tutelary → Schmitter & Karl (8).
    - Delegative → majority rule yes, **minority rights no**.

8. Autocracies: Linz & Stepan Typology

Keywords: Not Free, authoritarian, totalitarian, post-totalitarian, sultanistic

8.1 Ways of Being "Not Free" (slide 33)

Keywords: personalist, monarchy, military, one-party, theocracy, paper rights

- Ruled by **personal dictators, kings, generals, single parties, or theocrats**.
- Most have constitutions guaranteeing rights **on paper** only.
- Linz & Stepan 1996 — four-fold typology of non-democratic regimes (memorise): **authoritarian, totalitarian, post-totalitarian, sultanistic**.

8.2 Totalitarianism (slide 35)

Keywords: total control, terror, Gentile, Mussolini, mass mobilisation, total ideology

- Totalitarianism — the state seeks to regulate every aspect of public and private life, including through extensive surveillance and terror.
- Gentile: the state gives "total representation of the nation and total guidance of national goals."
- Mussolini: "Everything within the state, nothing outside the state, nothing against the state."
- Features: **complete monopoly of power**; **active mass participation**; an **"all-encompassing" ideology** legitimising and guiding the regime.
- *Example:* communist — USSR (Stalin), China (Mao), North Korea (Kim Il Sung); nazi-fascist — Italy (Mussolini), Germany (Hitler).

8.3 Post-Totalitarianism (slide 36)

Keywords: incomplete totalitarianism, PRC, demobilisation, decline causes

- Full cases are **few** and gone for decades; USSR, PRC and fascist Italy were mostly incomplete totalitarianism.
- *Example:* the **PRC** became post-totalitarian after the party **de-emphasised ideology**, **abandoned mass mobilisation**, and **relaxed economic control**.

- **Why totalitarianism declined** (memorise):
    - **(i)** Total control of a large territory and millions of people is hard; **modernity** lets inconvenient information in.
    - **(ii)** "Total ideologies" were defeated in **WW2** and the **Cold War**.

8.4 Authoritarianism (slide 37)

Keywords: limited pluralism, flexible ideology, performance legitimacy, passive obedience

- Authoritarianism, contrasted with totalitarianism:
    - **Power** more constrained and dispersed — possibly **limited pluralism** (political or socio-economic).
    - **Ideology** less important, flexible; legitimacy from **tradition/culture, national security/interest, or economic performance**.
    - **Participation: passive obedience**, not active mobilisation.
- Textbook subtypes: **traditional**, **military** (bureaucratic-military), **religious**, **electoral** authoritarianism.
- One-liner: *totalitarianism demands belief and participation; authoritarianism only obedience.*

8.5 Sultanism (slide 38)

Keywords: personal rule, family plunder, personality cult, hereditary succession, no legitimacy

- Sultanism — power centred on an individual leader and his family, who amass extensive wealth by plundering state coffers.
- Features: **no constraints** on power; **cult of personality**; **all opposition banned**; **fear/surveillance**; **endemic corruption**; **hereditary succession**; typically **no legitimacy**; officials' power comes from **personal ties to the leader's family**.
- Evolved from:
    - *Example:* communist regimes — North Korea (Kim Il Sung), Romania (Ceaușescu).
    - *Example:* party-based authoritarianism — Iraq (Saddam Hussein), Syria (the Assads).
    - *Example:* military authoritarianism — Libya (Gaddafi), Indonesia (Suharto).
    - *Example:* electoral democracy — the Philippines (Marcos).
- → Defined by **personalism and predation**, not ideology; any regime can degenerate into it.

8.6 Quick Comparison

Keywords: pluralism, ideology, mobilisation, who holds power

- **Totalitarian:** no pluralism; total ideology; active mobilisation; party monopoly.
- **Post-totalitarian:** party monopoly survives; ideology, mobilisation, economic control relaxed.
- **Authoritarian:** limited pluralism; flexible ideology; passive obedience.
- **Sultanistic:** leader and family; personality cult; plunder; hereditary.
- → Classify any case by: pluralism? ideology? mobilisation or obedience? institutions or a family?

8.7 Eight Autocratic Subtypes: Siaroff's Table (slide 39)

Keywords: traditional, military, theocratic, electoral authoritarianism, pre-totalitarian, totalitarian, post-totalitarian, sultanism

- Siaroff 2022, after Linz & Stepan 1996, splits autocracy into eight subtypes on the same ten dimensions. Distinguishing features (memorise ideology, legitimacy, transition):
    - Traditional authoritarianism (monarchies): anything from no parties to multi-party elections that do not determine the government. **Traditional legitimacy**; leadership for life, then within the royal family. Transition: monarch accepts a **figurehead role**.
    - Military authoritarianism: parties usually banned. Often nationalistic, stressing economic development; **demobilizes** civil society. Legitimacy from claims to act in the **national interest**; leadership indefinite unless the military rotates power. Transition: when the military **loses legitimacy** (e.g. losing a war) or thinks it has restructured the socio-political order.
    - Theocratic authoritarianism: one party or none (anti-regime independents may be elected). **Ideology from a religious text or school**; religious mobilization. Legitimacy from authority to **interpret scripture**; a religious assembly chooses successors. Transition **has never occurred willingly**.
    - Electoral authoritarianism: several parties and real opposition, but elections cannot change the government. Many autonomous actors; stresses **economic growth and social peace**. Legitimacy from the **illusion of legal-rational authority**; prefers to be genuinely popular. Leadership indefinite unless party term limits (sometimes one term). Key step: **one truly free and fair election**.
    - Pre-totalitarianism / incomplete totalitarianism: one party with a monopoly; elaborate utopian ideology; **partial** mobilization. Legitimacy initially from **how it came to power** (elections, independence struggle). Transition: party must accept or be forced to give up its monopoly.
    - Full totalitarianism: one party; **terror** eliminates organized opposition; no pluralism and hostility to organized religion; **no civil liberties**. Utopian ideology; extensive **obligatory mobilization** with expected enthusiasm. Legitimacy from **ideology plus the dictator's charisma**; unpredictable leader. Transition only via a post-totalitarian phase, or defeat and foreign occupation.

    - Post-totalitarianism: party monopoly with the **beginnings of pluralism** (dissidents, market actors); ideology weakened, **enthusiasm replaced by boredom or careerism**. Shift to **performance legitimacy**; leaders constrained by party and technocrats, chosen peacefully by the oligarchy. Transition ranges from collapse to negotiated.
    - Sultanism: weakly institutionalized party; terror; **no ideology**, just glorification of leader and family. Compliance from **fear, rewards and personal ties**; arbitrary rule, no bureaucratic professionalism. Sultan rarely abdicates and must be **overthrown**, and his inner circle may then **hijack the transition**.

- One-liner: *ask what legitimates the ruler (tradition, nation, God, fake elections, ideology, performance, fear) and you can usually name the subtype.*

9. One-Page Revision Spine

Keywords: recap, capacity, democracy criteria, hybrids, autocracy types

1. **Three dimensions (slide 2):** national content, state capacity, regime.
2. **National content (slides 3–4):** multi-national vs sub-national states; nations exist in members' minds. **Stateness** (Linz & Stepan 1996) → citizenship disputes, secession/cleansing, no agreed rules → instability, weak democracy.
3. **State capacity (slides 5–7, Siaroff 2013):** effective (laws everywhere, legitimate everywhere) → flawed (corruption, riots) → weak (areas outside control) → collapsed (no authority; frontline war ≠ collapse). End 2021: Yemen, Libya (+ Somalia).
4. **Regime (slide 11):** formal/informal rules for selection, representation, repression; ≠ incumbents, coalition, policies.
5. **Athens (slides 12–13):** rule of the demos; agora, psephos, idiotes; lottery not elections; ~10% citizens.
6. **Przeworski (slide 14):** parties lose elections; institutionalised uncertainty.
7. **Polyarchy (Dahl 1982):** elected officials, free/fair elections, suffrage, right to run, expression, alternative information, association.
8. **Schmitter & Karl 1991:** no unelected veto; self-governing polity; against electoralism.
9. **Fukuyama 2011:** modern state (China) + rule of law + accountability (West).
10. **Slide 19:** popular sovereignty → elections; equal citizenship → limits on power, equal participation.
11. **Slide 20:** democracy = majority rule + minority rights; liberal vs electoral democracy; liberal autocracy.
12. **Freedom House:** Free / Partly Free / Not Free on political rights + civil liberties.
13. **Hybrids (slides 29, 32):** transitional vs entrenched; pseudo-democracy, competitive authoritarianism, tutelary, delegative.
14. **Autocracy (Linz & Stepan 1996):** totalitarian (total control, ideology, mobilisation) → post-totalitarian (PRC; relaxed) → authoritarian (limited pluralism, obedience) → sultanistic (family plunder, personality cult).
15. **Decline of totalitarianism:** control is impractical under modernity; total ideologies lost WW2 and the Cold War.

16. **Data (slides 8–10, 21–34):** state strength end 2021 (China effective, India flawed, Mexico weak; Libya and Yemen collapsed); Fragile States Index 0–120 (Norway best, Somalia worst); five indices (EIU 0–10, FH 0–100, Polity −10 to 10, V-Dem 0–1, IDEA 0–1); EIU 2024: only 6.6% of people live in full democracies.
17. **Table 4.1:** 195 regimes = 39 liberal + 67 electoral democracies + 48 semi-liberal + 41 closed autocracies.
18. **Table 4.2 + slide 39:** four regime types on ten dimensions; eight autocratic subtypes (traditional, military, theocratic, electoral, pre-totalitarian, totalitarian, post-totalitarian, sultanism), told apart by their **source of legitimacy**.